

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Versatile Senior PHP Developer with over 9 years of experience in designing, developing, and maintaining web solutions with a strong focus on eCommerce plugins, payment gateway integration, and scalable backend services. Specialized in building custom checkout plugins for platforms like WooCommerce, Shopify, Magento, and OpenCart. Demonstrated success using AI-assisted development tools to boost productivity and maintain code quality. Adept at crafting secure, high-performance plugins and APIs that enhance customer checkout experiences while meeting evolving fintech demands.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, SQL
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** Laravel, Symfony, React.js, Bootstrap
- **eCommerce Platforms:** WooCommerce, Magento 2, Shopify, PrestaShop, OpenCart
- **Databases:** MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL
- **Tools:** Git, GitHub Actions, Docker, Postman, Jira, Composer, Nginx
- **AI Tools:** GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Windsurf, TabNine, ChatGPT
- **CI/CD & DevOps:** GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Docker, DigitalOcean
- **Other:** REST APIs, Swagger/OpenAPI, Stripe/PayPal integrations, Agile/Scrum

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Sensidev

September 2021 – December 2024

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Developed and maintained scalable PHP-based checkout modules across WooCommerce and Magento, ensuring seamless integration with proprietary payment APIs for international clients.
- Spearheaded the development of a Shopify embedded app plugin for real-time currency conversion and checkout analytics, utilizing GraphQL APIs and Polaris UI framework.
- Integrated third-party CRM systems with OpenCart to automate order management and customer segmentation using webhook and RESTful interfaces.
- Refactored legacy Magento 1 modules to Magento 2 standards, optimizing load times and ensuring compatibility with latest PHP versions and marketplace policies.
- Employed GitHub Copilot and Windsurf to reduce plugin development cycle by 35%, leveraging auto-suggestions and AI-generated unit tests.

- Automated release and deployment pipelines for eCommerce plugins using GitHub Actions and Makefile scripts, improving delivery consistency.
- Created plugin monitoring and logging utilities to capture transaction anomalies in real-time, aiding in fraud detection and compliance checks.
- Documented all plugin installation guides, usage manuals, and API schemas for both internal teams and external clients, improving onboarding by 40%.

Software Engineer

Syscom Digital

October 2019 – August 2021

Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Engineered custom WooCommerce and PrestaShop plugins to support localized checkout experiences, such as address auto-fill, coupon logic, and loyalty point redemption.
- Collaborated with marketing teams to integrate AI-driven A/B testing modules into eCommerce platforms, enabling dynamic checkout flow adjustments based on user behavior.
- Designed dynamic plugin configuration dashboards using React and PHP backend, allowing non-technical staff to modify plugin behavior without code changes.
- Implemented webhook listeners in PHP for syncing order events with HubSpot CRM and other third-party logistics systems in near real-time.
- Created CI/CD pipelines with Docker and Jenkins to automate deployment of plugins and application microservices across development and staging environments.
- Wrote comprehensive unit and integration tests using PHPUnit to cover 95%+ of plugin logic and third-party API interactions.
- Led code reviews and knowledge-sharing sessions to mentor junior developers on best practices for secure plugin development and RESTful API design.
- Built a custom debugging tool to trace plugin execution paths during checkout processes and drastically reduced QA time for new releases.

Software Developer

Soft Build

June 2016 – July 2019

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Developed a custom Magento extension that connected with national banking APIs to facilitate direct bank transfers within the checkout process.
- Built lightweight microservices in PHP to handle webhook callbacks from payment gateways like Stripe, Paysera, and PayPal.
- Customized and optimized multiple WooCommerce payment plugins to meet PSD2 and SCA requirements across EU-based stores.
- Implemented multilingual and multi-currency features in Shopify and OpenCart plugins to expand merchant support across EMEA regions.
- Reduced plugin latency by optimizing database queries and adding caching layers using Redis and custom SQL indexes.
- Designed intuitive plugin admin panels using Bootstrap and jQuery, improving merchant control over checkout features.
- Participated in architecture planning sessions and migrated legacy plugins from procedural to modern OOP structure with proper namespaces.
- Worked closely with QA engineers to conduct cross-browser and responsive UI testing of frontend checkout flows.

Software Developer

Decima Digital

November 2015 – April 2016

Tallinn, Estonia

- Created lightweight PHP modules for PrestaShop and WooCommerce integrating alternative payment solutions for Baltic market.
- Maintained real-time logging tools that tracked order statuses and refunds from eCommerce plugins and exposed data via REST APIs.
- Configured Docker environments for testing plugins in isolation, ensuring compatibility with various PHP versions and plugin dependencies.
- Assisted in GDPR compliance updates for eCommerce plugins, adding opt-in/opt-out fields and cookie tracking notifications.
- Contributed to frontend improvements in checkout UIs with JavaScript validation and instant field feedback to enhance user experience.
- Deployed AI-based auto-tagging solutions for order classification using open-source Python ML models triggered by PHP APIs.
- Delivered technical documentation and how-to videos for plugin installation and customization, reducing client support tickets.
- Coordinated with client teams to integrate the plugins into real-world storefronts and debug deployment issues post-launch.

Software Developer Intern

Borna Technology

September 2014 – August 2015

Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Supported the development of internal plugins for WooCommerce to track real-time inventory levels using RESTful APIs.
- Built test suites for plugin validation using PHPUnit and wrote automation scripts for plugin compatibility checks with WordPress core updates.
- Refactored basic plugin structures to comply with PHP-FIG standards and improve maintainability.
- Created internal tools for comparing checkout drop-off rates across different plugin versions using basic data visualization.
- Participated in stand-ups and sprint retrospectives, gaining first-hand experience in Agile development environments.
- Applied AI-assisted code generation tools like TabNine to accelerate early development cycles and maintain high coding standards.
- Logged and tracked plugin issues in Jira, using bug triaging techniques to prioritize resolution based on business impact.
- Learned about secure coding practices, including input validation and CSRF protection for payment plugins.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- ❖ Certified Magento 2 Associate Developer (2021)

- ❖ WooCommerce Plugin Developer Certificate (2020)
 - ❖ GitHub Copilot Power User Masterclass (2023)
 - ❖ Shopify Partner Academy: App Development (2022)
 - ❖ Advanced PHP for Web Development (Udemy, 2019)
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PROJECTS

- ✓ **AI-Driven Plugin Validator:** Built a CLI tool to scan WordPress and Magento plugin codebases using AI tools like Cursor and GPT-4 to detect deprecated functions, security issues, and documentation gaps.
- ✓ **Shopify Smart Checkout Plugin:** Designed a Shopify plugin with predictive field prefill based on user geolocation and cart contents, increasing checkout completion by 18%.
- ✓ **Multi-Gateway Payment Manager:** Developed a Laravel-based platform for managing multiple payment providers and switching dynamically based on order rules and customer segments.
- ✓ **Real-Time Tax & VAT Calculator:** Created a microservice to auto-calculate EU VAT based on location and cart composition, integrated across WooCommerce, Magento, and OpenCart plugins.